ARTEMIS: User Feedback

Observations from 30 prospective users

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1. Purpose

This document records what potential users told the ARTEMIS team about the idea of a bounded, opt-in desktop assistant: one that works only inside folders the user chooses, always asks before changing anything, and can undo what it did. The central hypothesis of the project is that restricting an assistant to explicitly granted folders increases user trust and willingness to adopt it, without reducing its usefulness to an unacceptable degree.

2. Basis of the observations

Team members spoke with **30 people** about ARTEMIS. The group included **students, developers, HR professionals and non-technical (lay) users**. The idea was explained using the project pitch, and participants were also able to try the current prototype. The observations below are what these people said in those conversations. They were gathered in conversation and were not part of a controlled or statistically sampled study, so they are best read as directional evidence about how the idea is received.

Item	Detail
People spoken to	30
Backgrounds	Students, developers, HR, lay users
Material shown	The project pitch and the working prototype
Focus	Trust, willingness to adopt, overall reaction to the idea

3. Observations

3.1 Reaction to the overall idea

The overall idea was well received. Participants across all four backgrounds liked the concept of an assistant that stays inside folders they choose and asks for approval before it acts.

3.2 Trust

Participants were asked whether they would trust an assistant that works as ARTEMIS describes.

Response	People	Share of 30
Fully agree they would trust it	10	33%
Partly agree they would trust it	16	53%
Total expressing trust	**26**	**87%**
Did not express trust	4	13%

More than four in five participants (26 of 30) were willing to trust the assistant, and one in three agreed fully. Partial agreement came with a consistent condition: participants were willing to trust it **provided it does exactly what it says it does**. In other words, the trust they described rests on the assistant staying inside the boundaries and approval steps it promises, which is the behaviour the central hypothesis depends on.

3.3 Reaction to the current prototype

Participants who tried the application described it as **a proof of concept in its current form**. That judgement was about the maturity of the prototype, not about the idea. Despite it, participants said they would be **willing to adopt the final product**

as presented in the pitch.

3.4 Adoption

Participants who commented on adoption said they would be willing to adopt the finished product described in the pitch. Their stated willingness is tied to the product delivering the pitched behaviour in its final form, in particular the same promise of trust set out above.

4. Assessment against the central hypothesis

Part of the hypothesis	What the observations show
Restricting scope increases trust	**Supported.** 26 of 30 (87%) expressed trust, 10 of them fully; the remainder were conditional on the assistant doing exactly what it says.
Increases willingness to adopt	**Supported for the final product.** Participants were willing to adopt the product as pitched, while regarding the present version as a proof of concept.
Without unacceptably reducing usefulness	**Encouraging but not yet tested at scale.** Participants liked the idea and did not object to the limits, but a full judgement of usefulness depends on the finished product.

Taken together, these observations support the central hypothesis: a bounded, ask-first assistant was seen as trustworthy by a large majority of the people consulted, and they were willing to adopt it once it matures beyond a proof of concept.

5. What this means for the project

- **Keep the promises exact.** Trust was conditional on the assistant doing exactly what it says. The folder limit, the approval step and undo must behave as described, every time.
- **Move beyond proof of concept.** Participants separated the idea from the current prototype, so reliability and polish are the main route from approval to adoption.
- **Address the doubters.** Four of the 30 did not express trust. Understanding their reasons is a useful next step.

6. Limitations

- The sample is 30 people reached through the team's own contacts; it is not a random or representative sample.
- Responses were collected in conversation and summarised by the team. No individual scores or recordings are available.
- The breakdown of responses by background (students, developers, HR, lay users) was not tallied, so no group-level figures are claimed.
- The observations measure stated attitudes after a pitch and a short try of the prototype, not sustained use over time.

These limits mean the findings show a favourable direction, not a precise measurement. A follow-up with the finished product and recorded responses would strengthen the evidence.